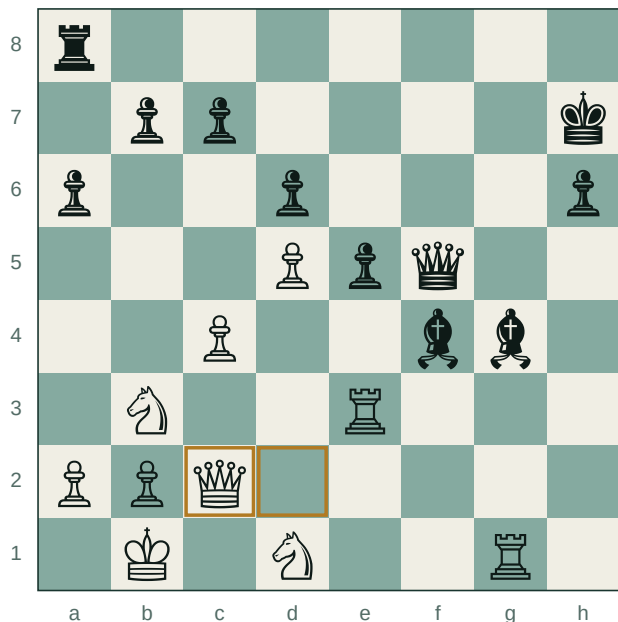


Attraction tactics: Black, move 27

Attraction tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 27.Qc2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27...Qxc2+ 28. Kxc2 Bxd1+ 29. Rxd1 Bxe3

27...Qxc2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From c2 it attacks king on b1, knight on d1 and knight on b3. Recorded reply: **28.Kxc2**.

28...Bxd1+ Check restricts White to 7 legal replies here. The move also takes the knight on d1. Recorded reply: **29.Rxd1**.

29...Bxe3 The bishop captures the rook on e3.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -3 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on b1. Absolute pin: queen on c2.